SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #12 · COMMUNITY AND NEIGHBORHOOD

# "I'll never escape where I grew up."

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## Where it often comes from

Some neighborhoods carry poverty, crime, addiction, or limited opportunity, and people who grow up there may feel marked for life. Others live in small towns where everyone knows their family history. We may feel trapped by the environment, by relationships that pull us back, or by the belief that leaving is impossible.

## What Scripture teaches

God said to Abram, "Leave your country, your kindred, and your father's household, and go to the land I will show you." The Lord promises, "I am about to do something new... I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert." Paul writes, "If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." Escape is not always about moving. Some are called to leave, and others to stay and be a light. Either way, where you grew up does not have to define where you are going.

> *"Then the LORD said to Abram, 'Leave your country, your kindred, and your father's household, and go to the land I will show you.'"* (Genesis 12:1).

## Also see

> "'Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old. Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.'" (Isaiah 43:18–19).

> "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11).

## Common self-statements

- I will always be trapped here.
- No one gets out.
- My past will follow me forever.
- I cannot become anything else.
- The pull of home is too strong.
- I do not know how to live differently.

## Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I cannot change.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining that I am stuck permanently.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either leave entirely or stay stuck.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling stuck and concluding that I am.

## Challenging questions

- What does “escape” mean to me, physically, emotionally, or both?
- Who has left or changed and how?
- What would a first realistic step look like?
- What parts of my background do I want to keep?
- Who can help me move forward?
- What does God say about new beginnings?

## Truth summary

> Where I grew up shaped me, but it does not decide my future. God makes ways in the wilderness, and in Christ I am a new creation. With wise steps and support, I can build a new path.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Will of God
- Guidance
- Hardship
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Thinking, Healthy

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God’s renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

Chain Breaker — Zach Williams
Christ offers rescue and freedom to people who feel trapped by their past.

Amazing Grace My Chains Are Gone — Chris Tomlin
Salvation and freedom come through grace rather than earning acceptance.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God’s steady mercy through changing circumstances.

*Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I'll never escape where I grew up"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I'll never escape where I grew up." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What does escape mean to me?
- ☐ Who has moved forward?
- ☐ What is my first step?
- ☐ What do I keep?
- ☐ Who can help?
- ☐ What does God say?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ God can make a way in the wilderness.
- ☐ I am a new creation in Christ.
- ☐ My past does not decide my future.
- ☐ Change can be gradual.
- ☐ I can keep what is good.
- ☐ I am not alone on this road.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ **Genesis 12:1**
  *"Then the LORD said to Abram, 'Leave your country, your kindred, and your father's household, and go to the land I will show you.'"*
- ☐ **Isaiah 43:18–19**
  *"'Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old. Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.'"*
- ☐ **2 Corinthians 5:17**
  *"Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"*

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A step forward: Each week, record one step toward the life you want.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Isaiah 43:18–19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God makes a way in the wilderness, and I am a new creation.""*
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Guidance" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- ☐ Define the goal. Write what "out" means for you.
- ☐ Find a guide. Ask someone who has moved forward for advice.
- ☐ Make a plan. Identify one skill, relationship, or resource to gain.
- ☐ Take a step. Do one thing this week toward it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never escape where I grew up": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | A step forward |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never escape where I grew up.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, You lead people out and make a way where there is none. Show me my next step, give me wise people to walk with, and help me honor my past while moving on. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*